

The SEO Content Engine, A→Z

How a website goes from invisible to found — every step, front to back, explained like you've never done SEO before. Twelve stages, five phases, zero jargon left undefined.

How to read this — 5 color-coded phases

- **FOUNDATION** — plug in the data & find what people search
- **INTELLIGENCE** — study competitors & make the plan
- **CREATION** — write it, grade it, add the human touch
- **LAUNCH** — link it, publish it, get it seen by Google
- **GROWTH** — improve on autopilot & scale to cities

START HERE

SEO in 60 seconds

Five words explain almost everything. Learn these and the rest clicks into place.



Search engine

Google (or an AI like ChatGPT). Someone types a question; it shows a ranked list of pages. Being near the top = getting found.



Crawl

A bot visits your page and reads it. If it never visits, you don't exist to Google. Step one, always.



Index

Google files your crawled page in its giant library. Only indexed pages can ever be shown to searchers.



Keyword

The exact phrase a person searches, e.g. "*how much does a casket cost.*" You write pages that answer specific keywords.



Rank / SERP

SERP = the results page. Your "rank" is your spot on it. Page 1 gets almost all the clicks; page 2 is a ghost town.



AEO / GEO

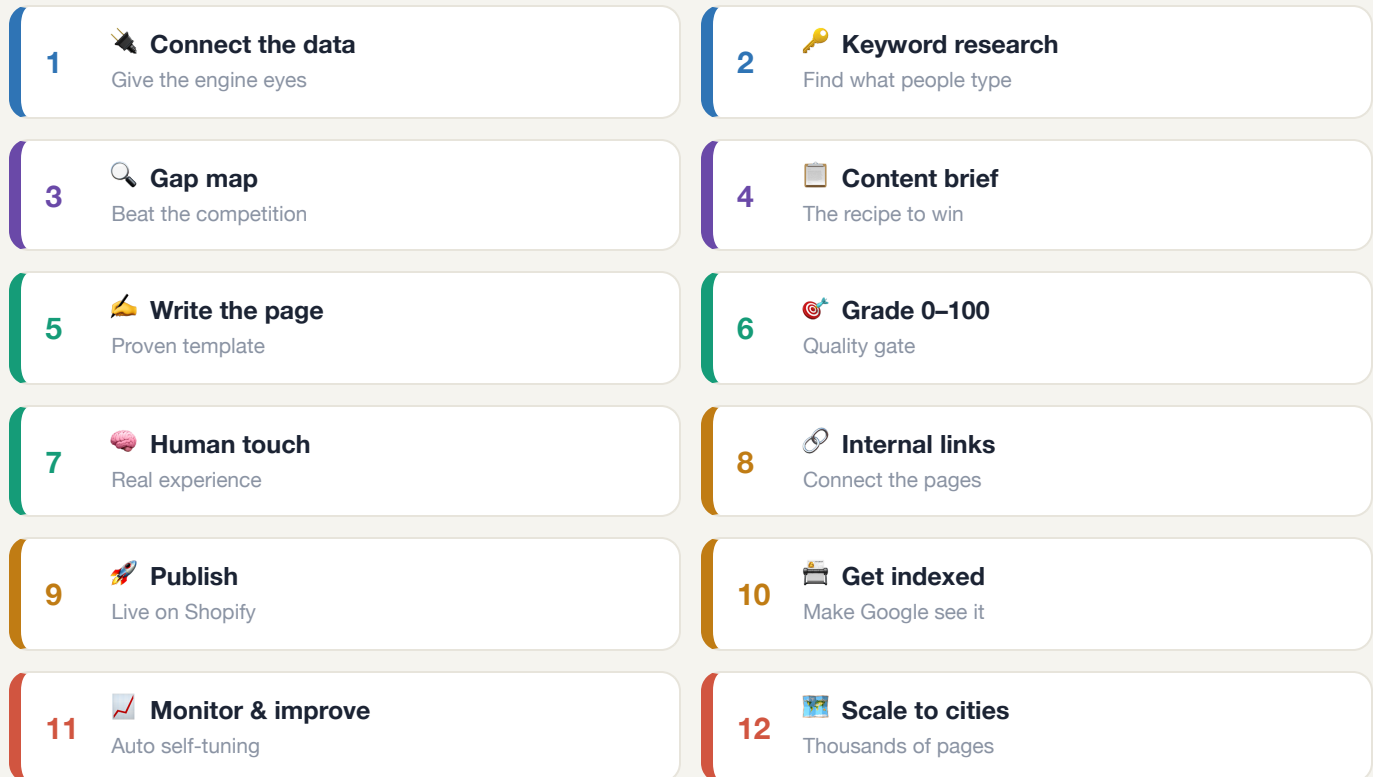
Getting AI answers to **quote your page** as their source. Huge now — many people read the AI answer and never click.

The one big idea 💡

Your Shopify store sells caskets. But a grieving family at 2am isn't typing "oak casket" — they're typing **what do I do when someone dies.** The engine's whole job is to answer **those** questions, become the helpful authority, and let the sale follow.

All 12 stages on one page

Read it top to bottom, left to right. Every stage feeds the next — and the last one loops back to the start, forever.



The whole thing in one breath

Connect data → find what families search → find the gap rivals miss → write a complete, quotable page → grade it to 90+ → add your human touch → link it in → publish → get indexed → watch & auto-improve → repeat at city scale.
Every cycle compounds.

 **ADHD-friendly promise:** you only ever touch **one** button — approving briefs at Stage 4. Everything else runs itself.

01

PHASE ONE

Foundation — give it eyes



STAGE 1

Connect the data

Before writing a word, plug in the facts — so the AI analyzes instead of guesses.

- › **Google Search Console (GSC)** — your free report card from Google: which searches showed your pages, how many saw you (impressions), clicked (clicks), and your average rank.
- › **DataForSEO** — a cheap pay-as-you-go data pipe to spy on the whole market: search volumes and which competitor pages rank.
- › **Google Analytics (GA4)** — what visitors do after they land (read, leave, or buy).

What it does: turns a confident guesser into an informed analyst. Everything downstream depends on this.

Caskets: GSC instantly reveals searches you already show up for but nobody clicks — the fastest money on the table.



STAGE 2

Keyword research

Find the exact phrases real people type — ranked by opportunity, not vibes.

- › Each keyword has a **volume** (how often it's searched) and an **intent** (what they actually want).
- › **Long-tail** = longer, specific phrases like "*cremation casket rental*" — lower volume but high intent, they convert best.
- › Cross-checks your GSC to find "**striking distance**" keywords (you're on page 2 — a small push wins page 1).

What it does: produces a prioritized map of what to write, ordered by easiest, biggest wins.

Caskets: "how much does a casket cost" (researching) vs "metal vs wood casket" (comparing) vs "what to do when someone dies" (scared, early, huge volume).

02

PHASE TWO

Intelligence — the plan



STAGE 3

Deep competitive research — the gap map

Study who's winning, then find the hole they all left open. That hole is your win.

- › Pulls the **top 10 pages** currently ranking for your topic.
- › **Reads each one** — length, subtopics, questions answered, data cited.
- › Grabs Google's "**People Also Ask**" questions.
- › Finds what everyone covers **and what nobody does** — your wedge.

What it does: guarantees your page is more complete than what's ranking — which is literally how you outrank it.

Caskets: "All 10 rivals list prices, but none break cost down by material or mention cremation-rental savings." → that's your page.



STAGE 4

The content brief — the recipe

Turn the research into a spec so the draft is engineered to win, not random.

- › Defines: target keyword, the angle, length, subtopics, questions to answer, data to include, and which labels (schema) to add.
- › This same brief becomes the **yardstick** the grader measures against later.
- › **This is the one place you click "approve."**

What it does: locks in a winning plan before any writing — and it's your single point of control.

Caskets: approve "Casket cost guide — by material + rental option, 1,800 words, FAQ + how-to schema" and walk away.

03

PHASE THREE

Creation — build & check



STAGE 5

Write the page

Draft in a structure tuned for both Google and AI.

- › Answer-first intro · table of contents · step-by-step how-tos · authoritative links · FAQ · gentle calls-to-action.
- › **Schema markup** = invisible labels telling Google "this is a FAQ / how-to / price" — like labeled tabs on a folder.
- › **Citable passages** = tight ~130–170-word chunks AI loves to quote. Ramble and you get skipped.

What it does: produces a draft structurally ready to rank *and* to be quoted by AI.



STAGE 6

The 0–100 quality grade

A rubric scores every draft. Below 85? It fixes its weak spots and re-grades — automatically.

- › Scores intent match, depth vs rivals, experience, schema/AEO, originality, linking, readability, conversion.
- › Loops "revise the weakest part → re-grade" until it passes.
- › **Every score is logged with the reason** — so you learn what "great" looks like over time.

What it does: no thin "AI slop" ever reaches your site — only pages that clear the bar.



STAGE 7

You add the human touch (E-E-A-T)

Google rewards content from someone who clearly knows the subject. That's you.

- › **E-E-A-T** = Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trust.
- › Add the 10% only you have: a real price you've seen, a common mistake families make, a genuine tip, a photo.

What it does: turns a good draft into a *trusted* one — the #1 reason real content beats pure AI slop.

Caskets: "Families often overpay the funeral home 3–5× for the same casket." One true line like that lifts the whole page.

04

PHASE FOUR

Launch — ship & get seen



STAGE 8

Internal linking

Link your pages to each other so Google can find them all and understand your site.

- › Google's crawler follows links — good linking helps it discover and index every page.
- › 3–5 relevant links per page, forward and backward, with anti-spam rules.

What it does: turns loose pages into a connected web Google ranks as a whole.

Caskets: the cost guide links to "metal vs wood" and to the actual product collection — readers and crawlers flow through.



STAGE 9

Publish to Shopify

The finished post goes live automatically through Shopify's native blog.

- › Pushed straight in via Shopify's Admin API — the clean path, no messy theme hacking.
- › On a schedule (a few posts a week) or on your click — your choice.

What it does: gets the page onto the live site with zero manual copy-paste.



STAGE 10

Get indexed

Published ≠ findable. Now we make Google actually crawl and file it.

- › Your **sitemap** (a list of all URLs) tells Google what exists.
- › For top pages, **request indexing** in GSC (~10/day) to jump the line.
- › Strong internal links speed up discovery of the rest.

What it does: moves the page from "published but invisible" to "in Google's library, eligible to rank."



STAGE 11

Monitor & self-improve

Once live, the engine watches GSC and keeps making pages better on its own.

- › **Striking distance** (rank 11–15) → push that page harder.
- › **High views, low clicks** → rewrite the title & meta description (the headline + summary in results) for an instant click lift.
- › **Decaying** old posts → refresh with new info.

What it does: your content keeps getting better instead of going stale.



STAGE 12

Scale with geo pages — the casket superpower

One template becomes thousands of unique, ranking city pages.

- › A page per city: "When a loved one passes in [City]: first steps, local funeral homes, what to expect."
- › Pulls **vett**ed local data (Google Maps API, filtered to 4.4★ / 20+ reviews) so you never list junk.
- › Genuinely helpful + a soft "compare casket prices" nudge.

What it does: you become the helpful authority in a moment of real need — Google & AI start recommending you, and families find you first.

Proof: Ryan's version hit 2,625 pages → 1.5M impressions → 5%+ conversion, one product line running with zero employees.

► Your next step

Start Stage 1 on **trustedcaskets.com** as the testbed — wire up GSC + DataForSEO and run the first live keyword + gap analysis. Prove it on the low-risk site, then bring the whole engine to **overnightcaskets.com**.